

Request for Information on Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan Development

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Advancing Ethical AI: A Policy and Research Imperative

1. Introduction

As a Cultural Studies scholar and former Instructor of Record in the Department of African American and African Diaspora Studies at Indiana University Bloomington, my academic and research trajectory intersects with artificial intelligence (AI) through initiatives such as the fairness, accessibility, inclusivity, and representation (FAIR) framework. My work is dedicated to examining how AI can serve as a transformative tool for equitable social engagement while mitigating structural biases. The goal of this response is to articulate a vision for AI development that prioritizes ethical integrity, transparency, and equity across multiple domains, including healthcare, policy-making, and historical preservation.

AI remains in its developmental phase, requiring sustained oversight to ensure that embedded biases are systematically identified and either minimized or wholly eradicated. The research community must generate rigorous, evidence-based frameworks that not only acknowledge AI's vast potential but also address its limitations in reinforcing systemic inequities. By leveraging AI as an innovative mechanism for research, diagnostics, and social reform, we can ensure that its applications remain aligned with established ethical imperatives. Furthermore, the expansion of interdisciplinary AI research across academic and policy sectors must prioritize methodologies that holistically integrate the human experience into machine-learning paradigms.

2. Addressing Algorithmic Bias: A Framework for Inclusive AI Development

The entrenched biases in AI models—rooted in historical data disparities and algorithmic distortions—underscore the necessity for proactive mitigation strategies. Areas of primary concern include:

- The **systemic underrepresentation of diverse cultural epistemologies** in AI training sets, resulting in skewed or exclusionary outputs.
- The **risk of AI-mediated cultural appropriation and misrepresentation**, further exacerbating historical erasures.
- The potential for **Tiered Data Access models**, to serve as prototypes for ensuring dataset integrity and transparency in AI development.
- The disproportionate allocation of AI research funding, favoring institutions with pre-existing infrastructural advantages, thus limiting the potential for truly representative technological development.

Ethical AI frameworks must incorporate **culturally responsive methodologies, comprehensive model audits, and participatory approaches that include historically marginalized voices**. Further, robust **mechanisms for interdisciplinary collaboration** must be instituted to ensure that AI research remains integrative, reflective of societal complexities, and free from the limitations of a singular disciplinary perspective.

3. AI in Biomedical Research: Ethical and Epistemological Considerations

AI's increasing role in medical and genetic research necessitates stringent oversight to prevent the perpetuation of scientific bias. Critical considerations include:

- The propensity for **racialized and stigmatized interpretations of genetic data**, which have historically informed exclusionary medical practices.
- The imperative for **federal oversight mechanisms** to regulate AI applications in gender-affirming healthcare and reproductive rights.
- The ethical implications of **AI-driven genetic analyses**, ensuring that such inquiries do not reinforce pathologizing narratives or pseudoscientific racial classifications.
- The potential of AI to refine **early-detection methodologies in public health**, ensuring that diagnostic tools are equitably designed and accessible.
- The need for **stringent regulatory frameworks** to ensure that AI-driven healthcare applications do not compromise patient privacy, data integrity, or clinical autonomy.

Federal policies must mandate **interdisciplinary review committees, diverse data collection protocols, and public accountability measures to safeguard AI's role in biomedical ethics**.

4. AI, FAIR Principles, and the Socio-Political Landscape

The ongoing de-prioritization of FAIR-centered policies—particularly under initiatives such as *Project 2025's Mandate for Leadership* proposes a significant threat to AI's equitable deployment. Key areas of concern include:

- The instrumentalization of AI to **cancel or de-legitimizes discourses on political injustices, civil rights, and reproductive autonomy**.
- The increased likelihood of **algorithmic employment discrimination** disproportionately impacting historically marginalized professionals.
- The deployment of AI technologies to **undermine grassroots social movements through digital disinformation campaigns and biased content filtering**.
- The rising use of **predictive AI policing models**, which often reinforce racial profiling and institutional surveillance, exacerbating disparities in the criminal justice system.

- The corporate monopolization of AI development, preventing open-source and community-driven AI projects from gaining traction in ethical technological advancements.

To counteract these threats, federal policy must enact **regulatory safeguards, establish anti-discriminatory AI governance models, and ensure accessibility in AI research and development.**

5. Ethical AI and the Politics of Narrative Control

The proliferation of AI-generated content raises urgent questions regarding authorship, narrative agency, and cultural integrity. Without ethical frameworks, AI systems may:

- **Erase or distort historically significant narratives**, leading to epistemic violence against marginalized communities.
- **Disseminate misinformation or algorithmically reinforce harmful stereotypes**, thereby sustaining sociocultural inequities.
- **Suppress counter-hegemonic discourses**, diminishing the ability of marginalized communities to self-represent within digital ecosystems.
- **Centralize content creation within proprietary AI systems**, limiting the scope for independent voices and small-scale cultural producers to shape their narratives.

Regulatory interventions must include:

- **Comprehensive disclosure policies for AI-generated content**, ensuring transparency in digital authorship.
 - **Public investment in culturally representative AI initiatives**, fostering the development of technologies that amplify rather than appropriate community narratives.
 - **Expanded ethical review processes for AI-integrated media**, preventing the entrenchment of misinformation within algorithmic content distribution systems.
 - **Support for AI literacy programs**, equipping communities with the knowledge to critically assess and challenge AI-generated content.
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6. Policy and Structural Recommendations

To address the outlined concerns, the following policy measures should be prioritized:

1. Implementation of **federal AI oversight and auditing mechanisms** to detect and eliminate systemic bias in datasets.

2. Mandatory **transparency requirements in AI training data** to ensure the fair representation of historically marginalized communities.
 3. Establishment of **multidisciplinary AI review boards**, incorporating scholars from the humanities, social sciences, and STEM disciplines to provide holistic assessments of AI applications.
 4. Investment in **AI research initiatives led by underrepresented scholars and practitioners**, promoting diverse and inclusive AI innovation.
 5. Development of **impact assessment protocols for AI integration in academia and research**, ensuring alignment with ethical research standards and accessibility goals.
 6. Expansion of **federal funding for AI research in social justice and public policy**, emphasizing AI's potential in addressing systemic societal inequities.
 7. The creation of **an independent federal AI ethics commission**, ensuring ongoing, transparent review of AI advancements across all sectors.
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7. Conclusion

As AI continues to shape the contours of research, policy, and digital storytelling, it is imperative that its development is guided by ethical rigor, interdisciplinary expertise, and an unwavering commitment to inclusivity.

I urge the OSTP and NITRD to integrate these recommendations into the AI Action Plan to ensure that future developments in AI adhere to the highest ethical and equitable standards.

Submitted with a firm commitment to fostering an AI landscape rooted in justice and integrity,

Mr. Floyd Daniel Hobson III